

Chapter 72 - Sickle

Yan Lin looked at Feng Yue, who had almost recovered, and her tense and worried mood relaxed considerably.

"How are you feeling?" Yan Lin's voice was gentle, and even her gaze carried deep affection and care.

A clear sweet plum flavor burst in Feng Yue's mouth. With the candy in her mouth, it wasn't convenient to speak. She glanced at Yan Lin and then looked away, as if burned by the emotion in the other person's eyes.

She turned her head to look at the candy wrapper lying in her palm and nodded with an "mm."

Seeing this, Yan Lin breathed a sigh of relief. She looked at the examination list in her hand and said: "This should be the last item. Shall we go to the conference room now? Or would you like to go outside for some fresh air?"

"Let's go back." Feng Yue used her tongue to push the candy to the left side of her cheek, making her speech somewhat unclear.

Yan Lin nodded and turned toward the exit of the restroom.

Feng Yue watched as she turned around, holding the bottle of mineral water she had partially drunk in one hand and her examination forms in the other.

Feng Yue suddenly called out to stop her: "Yan Lin."

Yan Lin turned to look at her.

Feng Yue stepped forward, reached out to take back the things that belonged to her from Yan Lin's hands, then stepped back to put some distance between them.

She then looked into those eyes that she had once desperately longed to be noticed by, her expression as calm as a windless, waveless lake: "This will probably be the last time I say these things to you. I hope you can really listen to what I'm saying."

Feng Yue's tone, as if she were delivering a last will and testament, made Yan Lin's heart panic: "What... what?"

"I'm very clear about your physical condition, so when you saved me before, I was very grateful. So I can write off all our past grievances with a clean slate. But I also hope you can understand that no matter how you treat me, no matter whether you've truly rekindled old feelings for me..."

At this point, Feng Yue paused, the corners of her mouth turning up in an ambiguous smile, as if she were mocking herself or stating a fact she herself was unwilling to admit.

"I hope you can give up all thoughts about me. You and I are destined to be people from two different worlds. We will have our own lives and endings. Since we already have the result of our failed experiment, why try to force ourselves together again?" By the end, Feng Yue's voice grew softer and softer.

Yan Lin could vaguely sense that Feng Yue was intentionally alluding to something, but she still had no clue about the true meaning.

Feng Yue watched Yan Lin's expression grow increasingly ugly, lowered her eyelashes and sighed softly: "We—"

"Should never see each other again." Feng Yue's voice sounded firm and forceful, without any room for negotiation.

This short sentence made Yan Lin's heart feel as if it were being torn apart alive, causing pain and suffocation.

The acrid feeling at the tip of her nose made her eyes heat up, and mist instantly filled her entire eyes.

Feng Yue's calmness and words were like pairs of hands pushing her into that purgatory called "never see each other again."

Yan Lin suddenly deeply understood that the gap between her and Feng Yue wasn't just about "love or not love."

There was also the matter of "see or not see" that came before that.

Suddenly, an enormous sense of dejection and loneliness swept over Yan Lin, dragging her into that hell filled with raging flames.

Yan Lin struggled and resisted, but what she got in return was her almost voiceless, silent roar.

Blood and energy churned in her heart, and instantly her cheeks and the base of her ears flushed red. She had many words she could use to refute the other person, but at this moment, she felt those words were meaningless.

That invisible thread that Feng Yue had personally tied between them twelve years ago had broken.

They could never be tied together again.

Her hands hanging by her sides had already clenched into fists, and she didn't even care that her nails were digging deep into her flesh.

Feng Yue looked at her deeply, then stepped past her as they brushed shoulders.

It was enough to experience a mistake once. Feng Yue would never fall into the same pit twice.

So, until Feng Yue finished her physical examination and carefully listened to Dr. Wendell's diagnosis, she never saw Yan Lin at the hospital again.

When she got up to leave, Wendell asked in confusion: "Did your wife leave first?"

Feng Yue was stunned. If she had heard correctly, Wendell had indeed used the word "wife."

Feng Yue didn't know what had given Wendell this misimpression, so she explained her relationship with Yan Lin to him, though she only mentioned that they were "ex-wives," not the "wife" relationship Wendell had referred to.

Wendell was more shocked than surprised by this, but he still apologized to Feng Yue and explained his reason for saying that.

Only then did Feng Yue learn that Wendell had indeed been specially invited to Beijing by Yan Lin, and that she hadn't gone to Germany just once.

Until Feng Yue got back in her car, she was still thinking about Yan Lin's trip to Germany to seek medical help for her.

According to Wendell, the timing of Yan Lin's last trip to Germany coincided with when a bunch of German health supplements had appeared at her home.

Feng Yue remembered that pile of health supplements that her mother had specifically brought to her attention, earnestly instructing her to remember to take them, saying they were specially brought back from abroad by a friend she had asked.

It seemed that her mother's made-up "friend" was most likely Yan Lin.

Although Feng Yue found her mother's acceptance of Yan Lin's gifts troublesome, she could understand it.

Her mother was just an ordinary mother who would naturally try various methods to make her child healthy.

In the end, all of this was caused by her illness.

Feng Yue couldn't accept Yan Lin's gifts and care without reservation, so she planned to return the money for those health supplements to her.

But this matter wasn't urgent right now. After she went abroad, she could ask someone else to return it, which would be much quieter.

Feng Yue had obtained Dr. Wendell's examination report. Her physical condition was very good, and everything was developing in a positive direction.

When she returned home, she naturally showed this report to her parents. Only then did the two parents' worries about whether Feng Yue could handle long-distance flights diminish.

They had already contacted Feng Yue's uncle Jiang Pingrui in Vancouver, who naturally welcomed his family's visit with 120% enthusiasm.

So on the twenty-eighth day of the twelfth lunar month¹, Papa Feng gathered all his relatives for a meal and announced to everyone the arrangement to spend New Year in Vancouver.

Although Feng Yue's several aunts felt this was somewhat inappropriate, they had no way to influence Papa Feng's decision.

Therefore, the next day, Feng Yue's family of three picked up Feng Yue's grandparents and boarded a plane to Vancouver.

However, before leaving, Feng Yue did have dinner with Wen Zhen.

She clearly knew that according to her plan, this meeting with Wen Zhen might be the last time they would see each other.

So Feng Yue set the location for this meal at her house in Song He Bay, where she personally prepared a table full of dishes to host Wen Zhen.

Wen Zhen knew she was going abroad for New Year, so she had prepared New Year gifts to bring to Feng Yue.

That New Year gift was none other than the ring that Fu Sixue had previously picked up.

However, to make her purpose less obvious, Wen Zhen also brought many other things as cover.

Feng Yue didn't realize that among that pile of gifts was a ring hiding Wen Zhen's feelings. All her attention was focused on the interesting stories Wen Zhen was telling.

The two sat across from each other at the dining table, both having drunk a little and feeling slightly tipsy.

The light in front of Wen Zhen was somewhat blurred, which made her notice when looking at Feng Yue that she seemed to be gilded with a layer of golden light in her eyes, very much like the pure and sacred goddess from mythology.

Wen Zhen laughed at her own far-fetched fantasy, and Feng Yue looked at her with confusion.

But she didn't say anything, just lowered her eyelashes and suppressed the complex emotions in her heart.

Wen Zhen could be said to be her first real friend. Although Wen Zhen's feelings for her had taken an unexpected turn later, this didn't prevent Feng Yue from seeing her as one of her best friends.

"After I go to Vancouver for New Year this time, I should also travel with my parents for a while. So we probably won't be able to sit together for meals and chat like this for a long time. It feels a bit regrettable..."

As she spoke, Feng Yue looked toward the window, hiding the true emotions in her eyes.

Wen Zhen was as gentle as always: "It doesn't matter. If you miss me, you can video call or phone me. This is the age of technology - being in different countries isn't a big deal."

Feng Yue pursed her lips and nodded: "Mm, I will."

The two smiled at each other and raised their glasses to clink them lightly.

"Speaking of which, we really seem to have bad timing. During New Year's, you were abroad while I was domestic, and now for Spring Festival it's the opposite - you're domestic while I'm abroad. We always seem to be missing each other, haha."

Hearing this, Wen Zhen's expression stiffened. She didn't understand whether Feng Yue was just speaking casually or was using this to politely reject her.

She steadied her mind and smiled: "What's the big deal? It's just that this year's New Year is like this. In the future, I'll spend every holiday with you."

Feng Yue laughed heartily: "Great! Then I'll thank Sister Wen Zhen in advance!"

After that, the two chatted about other topics, as if those words were just something Feng Yue had said unintentionally, without any hidden meaning.

After dinner, Wen Zhen said goodbye to Feng Yue. Downstairs, she leaned against her car, letting the cold wind clear her head while waiting for a designated driver.

Feng Yue's words were still etched in her mind, disturbing her and making her irritated.

She reached into her coat pocket, wanting to smoke a cigarette by the roadside to calm down, but instead her hand touched a familiar small box with a familiar texture.

Wen Zhen took the item out. The small velvet box that shouldn't have been there was now lying quietly in her palm.

She stared at the small box unblinkingly for a while, then slowly tilted her head back and exhaled.

The white mist from her breath tumbled in the air, seeming to instantly blur her eyes and make everything in front of her hazy.

So it wasn't her imagination - everything had traces that could be followed.

Feng Yue's words hadn't come out of nowhere either.

Feng Yue had once again politely rejected her in a wordless yet gentle way.

She was indeed as bright and gentle as the moon in the sky, but she also had wrists as sharp and decisive as a sickle.

Clean and decisive, without any dragging, and not giving you the slightest chance to misunderstand.

Footnotes:

1. **Twenty-eighth day of the twelfth lunar month (腊月二十八)** - This refers to the 28th day of the last month in the traditional Chinese lunar calendar, which is typically just a few days before Chinese New Year (Spring Festival).